

Absolutely — **online** is a useful secondary polysemy/grammar target because your passage uses it here:

> “...in documentaries and **online museum collections**...”

Here **online** means **available or accessible through the internet**. But the word also has important uses for **being connected to a network, internet-based activity, bringing systems into operation, and the contrast with offline**.

Word family: **online / offline**

Base form: online

Part of speech: adjective (形容詞) / adverb (副詞)

Related contrast: offline

Unlike words such as *documentary* or *collection*, **online** is mostly a modern technology/polyfunctionality word.

Meaning in your passage: **online = available on the internet — 網上的 ; 在線的**

Your phrase:

> “online museum collections”

Here **online** means:

> **available to view or access through the internet rather than only in a physical museum.**

繁體中文 :

可透過互聯網查看、使用或存取的 ; 網上的 / 在線的

Natural translation:

> “online museum collections”

「**網上博物館館藏**」

So here:

> **online = 透過互聯網提供 / 可在網上存取的**

1. **online + noun = internet-based / available on the internet — 網上的 ; 線上的**

The core adjective use.

Practice 1

> “The museum has an **online exhibition**.”

「博物館有一個**網上展覽**。」

Practice 2

> “I found the image in an online archive.”

「我在一個**網上檔案庫**找到那張圖片。」

online + noun = 透過互聯網提供、進行或存取的

Common:

- * online course
- * online shop
- * online banking
- * online museum
- * online class

2. **be online = connected to / using the internet — 已連線；在線上**

A major predicative use.

Practice 3

> “The computer is **online** now.”

「電腦現在已經**連上網絡**。」

Practice 4

> “Are you online?”

「你現在**在線嗎 / 有上線嗎**？」

be online = 裝置或使用者目前已連接互聯網 / 網絡

3. **go online = 上網；連上網**

A very common verb-complement pattern.

Practice 5

> “I went **online** to look for the painting.”

「我**上網**找那幅畫。」

Practice 6

> “More people went online during the event.”

「活動期間有更多人**上線 / 上網**。」

go online = 開始連接或使用互聯網

4. **online = through the internet (副詞) — 在網上；透過網絡**

Practice 7

> “You can buy the print **online**.”

「你可以**在網上**購買這幅印刷品。」

Practice 8

> “The tickets are sold online.”

「門票**在線上 / 網上**發售。」

online — adverb = 透過互聯網進行某個動作

5. **online = internet-based rather than face-to-face — 線上的；遙距的**

A major modern contextual use.

Practice 9

> “The lecture was held **online**.”

「這場講座以**網上形式**舉行。」

Practice 10

> “She attends online classes twice a week.”

「她每星期上兩次**網課**。」

****online = 透過互聯網進行，而不是實體面對面****

This is common in:

- * education
- * meetings
- * events
- * consultations

6. ****online = active/available on a networked system — 上線的；可用的****

A broader technical/system sense.

Practice 11

> “The new server is now ****online****.”

「新伺服器現在已經****上線並可使用****。」

Practice 12

> “The payment system is back online.”

「付款系統已經****恢復上線 / 恢復運作****。」

****online = 系統已接入網絡並處於可使用 / 運作狀態****

This is broader than simply “someone is using the internet”.

7. ****bring something online = 使……上線；投入運作****

A common technical/business pattern.

Practice 13

> “The company brought the new platform **online** last month.”

「公司上個月讓新平台正式**上線**。」

Practice 14

> “The museum plans to bring more collections online.”

「博物館計劃把更多館藏**放到網上開放**。」

bring X online = 令系統、服務或資源開始連網並投入使用 / 公開存取

8. **come online** = 上線；投入使用

Practice 15

> “The new website came **online** yesterday.”

「新網站昨天正式**上線**。」

Practice 16

> “Several new services came online this year.”

「今年有幾項新服務正式**投入運作**。」

come online = 開始上線、開始運作或開始可供使用

9. **online presence** = 網上存在感；網絡曝光 / 平台存在

A common business/media compound.

Practice 17

> “The gallery has a strong **online presence**.”

「這間畫廊有很強的**網上存在感 / 網絡曝光度**。」

Practice 18

> “Small businesses need a clear online presence.”

「小型企業需要建立清晰的**網上形象**。」

****online presence = 某人 / 機構在網站、社交平台等網絡渠道中的可見度和活動存在****

10. ****online community = 網上社群****

Practice 19

> “The artist has a large ****online community**** of followers.”

「這位藝術家有一個龐大的****網上社群****。」

Practice 20

> “Online communities can connect people with similar interests.”

「****網上社群****可以把興趣相近的人連結起來。」

****online community = 主要透過互聯網互動、交流的人群****

11. ****online platform = 網上平台；線上平台****

Practice 21

> “The museum uses an ****online platform**** to display its collection.”

「博物館使用一個****網上平台****展示館藏。」

Practice 22

> “The course is delivered through an online platform.”

「這個課程透過****網上平台****提供。」

****online platform = 讓使用者透過互聯網進行某類活動或存取內容的數碼服務系統****

12. ****online store/shop = 網店****

Practice 23

> “The museum has an **online shop**.”

「博物館有一間**網店**。」

Practice 24

> “You can order the reproduction from their online store.”

「你可以從他們的**網上商店**訂購複製畫。」

online shop/store = 透過互聯網瀏覽和購買商品的商店

13. **online banking** = 網上銀行服務

Practice 25

> “I paid for the print through **online banking**.”

「我透過**網上銀行服務**支付那幅印刷品。」

Practice 26

> “Online banking makes transfers easier.”

「**網上銀行**令轉帳更方便。」

online banking = 透過互聯網管理銀行帳戶、付款及轉帳等服務

14. **offline** = not connected to the internet/network — 離線的；未連線的

The major contrast word.

Practice 27

> “The computer is currently **offline**.”

「這部電腦目前**離線 / 未連線**。」

Practice 28

> “The website is temporarily offline.”

「網站暫時**無法連線 / 下線**。」

****offline = 沒有連接互聯網 / 網絡，或服務目前不可在線使用****

15. ****offline = in the physical/non-internet world — 線下的；實體的****

A modern contrastive use.

Practice 29

> “The exhibition is available both online and ****offline****.”

「這個展覽在線上和****線下 / 實體場地****都可以看到。」

Practice 30

> “They moved the discussion offline.”

「他們把討論轉到****線下 / 私下****進行。」

****offline = 不透過公開網絡進行，而是在實體或非網上環境中進行****

Important distinction: ****online vs on the internet****

****online****

compact adjective/adverb:

> online museum

> buy online

****on the internet****

prepositional phrase:

> available on the internet

Meaning overlaps strongly.

But:

> online course 

> *on-the-internet course* 

So **online** is the normal adjective.

Important distinction: **online** vs **digital**

online

= connected to / delivered through the internet.

digital

= stored or processed electronically.

A file can be **digital** but stored entirely offline.

So:

> digital image

> = 數碼圖片

> online image

> = 可在網上存取的圖片

Not the same.

Important distinction: **online** vs **virtual**

online

= internet-based.

virtual

often means simulated/non-physical, especially an experience/environment.

> online meeting

> = 網上會議

> virtual museum tour

> = 虛擬博物館導覽

A virtual experience is usually online, but **virtual** emphasizes simulation.

Important distinction: **online vs remote**

online

= internet-based.

remote

= done from another location.

> online class

> = 網課

> remote work

> = 遙距工作

Remote work often uses online tools, but the core idea is location, not internet access itself.

Important distinction: **online vs live**

These are not opposites.

An event can be:

* online and live

* online and recorded

* offline and live

So:

> online = where/how it is delivered

> live = happening in real time

Important distinction: **online vs connected**

connected

broad:
linked to a device/network/system.

online

usually:
connected and available for network/internet use.

A device may be connected locally without being online.

Important distinction: **online vs available online**

online

can describe the medium:

> online course

available online

emphasizes access:

> the catalogue is available online

Your source:

> online museum collections

means collections **made accessible through the internet**.

Important distinction: **go online vs come online**

go online

often from the user/device perspective:

> start using/connect to internet.

come online

often from the system/service perspective:

> become available/operational.

> “I went online.”

> = 我上網了。

> “The service came online.”

> = 服務上線了。

Important distinction: **online — person vs system**

Person:

> “She is online.”

= 她在線 / 已上線。

System:

> “The server is online.”

= 伺服器已上線並可運作。

Same word, different subject type.

Important distinction: **online collection vs physical collection**

online collection

= digitized/accessed via the internet.

physical collection

= actual objects held in a museum/archive.

An online museum collection may contain:

- * images

- * descriptions

- * metadata

- * digitized records

It is not necessarily the physical object itself.

Important spelling note: ****online****

Modern standard spelling is:

> ****online****

one word.

Older forms such as:

> on-line

are now much less common.

Family/usage sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern inventory includes:

****online + noun**** = 網上的 / 線上的
****be online**** = 在線 / 已連線
****go online**** = 上網 / 上線
****online — adverb**** = 在網上 / 透過網絡
****online class/event**** = 網上 / 遙距形式
****system online**** = 系統已上線 / 可用
****bring X online**** = 使.....上線 / 投入運作
****come online**** = 開始上線 / 可用
****online presence**** = 網上形象 / 網絡曝光
****online community**** = 網上社群
****online platform**** = 網上平台
****online shop**** = 網店
****online banking**** = 網上銀行服務
****offline — technical**** = 離線 / 未連線
****offline — real-world**** = 線下 / 實體形式

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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online + noun	透過互聯網提供、進行或可存取的	
be online — person/device	使用者或裝置目前已連接互聯網 / 網絡	
online — adverb	透過互聯網進行某個動作	
online — class/event	透過互聯網而非實體面對面進行的	
online — system	系統已連接網絡並處於可使用 / 運作狀態	
bring X online	令服務、系統或資源開始連網並投入使用	
come online	開始上線、開始運作或可供使用	
online presence	某人 / 機構在網絡渠道中的可見度及活動存在	
online community	主要透過互聯網互動和交流的群體	
online platform	供使用者透過互聯網存取內容或進行活動的數碼系統	
offline — technical	沒有連接網絡 / 互聯網的	
offline — physical	不透過網絡，而在實體或線下環境中進行的	

For your original sentence

> “I later saw it again in documentaries and ****online museum collections****...”

The exact meaning is:

****online = 博物館把部分館藏資料、圖片和介紹放到互聯網上，讓人可以遠端查看和存取****

Natural translation:

> ****「後來我又在紀錄片和網上博物館館藏中看到它。」****

The highest-value contrasts are:

- > ****online museum collection**** → 網上博物館館藏
- > ****buy online**** → 在網上購買
- > ****be online**** → 在線 / 已連線
- > ****go online**** → 上網
- > ****system comes online**** → 系統正式上線
- > ****online class**** → 網課
- > ****online presence**** → 網上形象 / 曝光
- > ****offline**** → 離線 / 線下
- > ****online vs digital**** → 互聯網上的 vs 數碼形式的